TaxWise

A Retrieval-Augmented Assistant for Australian Work-Related Tax Deductions

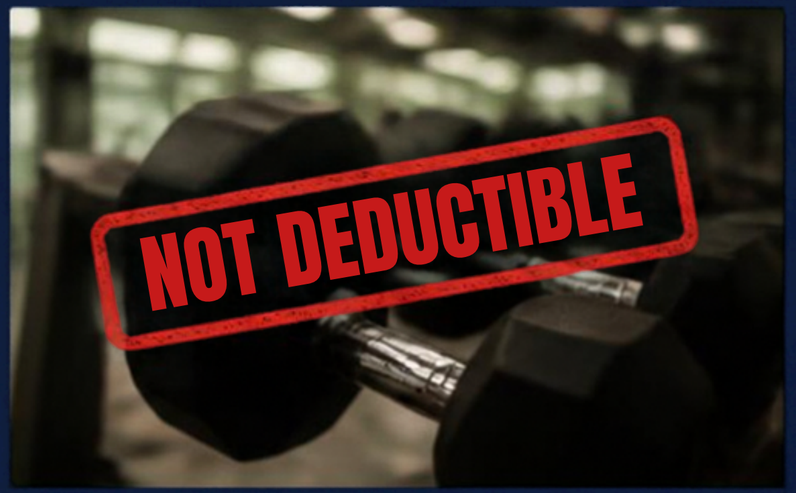
Grounded in official ATO guidance.

Cited sources.

Knows when to say "I don't know."

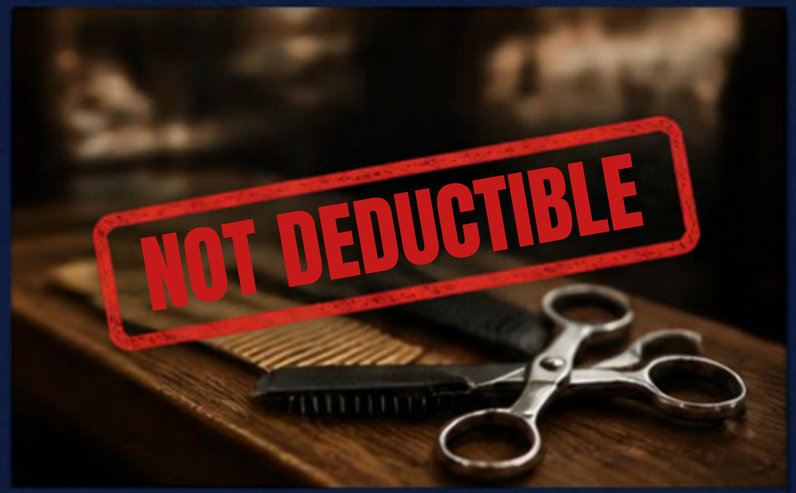
Project RAG

Deductible?
Tax rules are full of exceptions



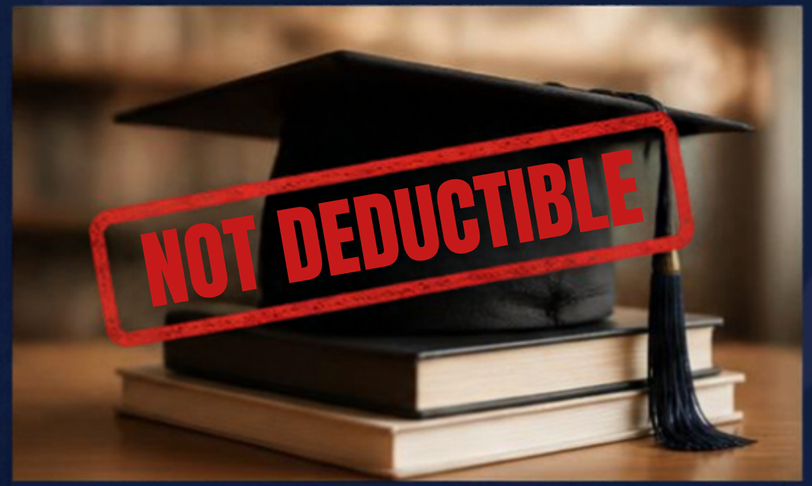
Gym membership

Not deductible, except in very rare fitness-critical jobs



A haircut

Personal grooming is a private expense, even for on-camera work



School fees

Not deductible, even when framed as professional development

**A generic chatbot guesses or quotes outdated rules.
We built a system that answers from real ATO guidance, and refuses rather than make something up.**

From ATO guidance to a grounded answer

Source
51 ATO pages
on work-related deductions

Chunk
366 chunks
split on natural boundaries

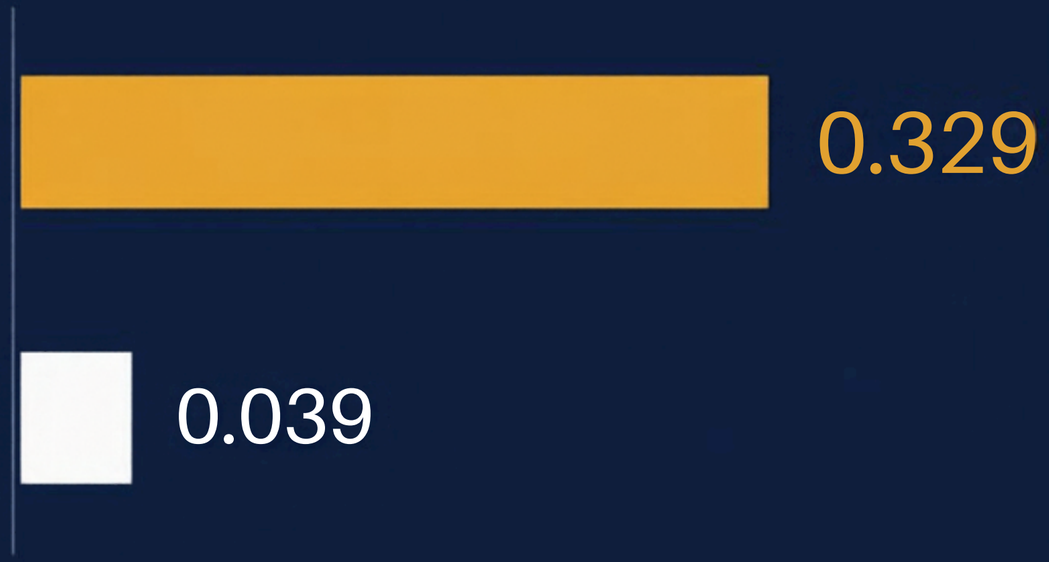
Embed
free local
embeddings, no cost

Retrieve
ChromaDB
+ a relevance gate

Answer
cites sources,
or admits it doesn't know

Baseline check

We reproduced RMIT's Walert RAG pipeline on its own dataset.



~8x better

confirming RAG was the right approach before adapting it to tax.

Live demo

Watch it think – and know its limits

1. **What car expenses can I claim?**
   Answered with cited ATO sources

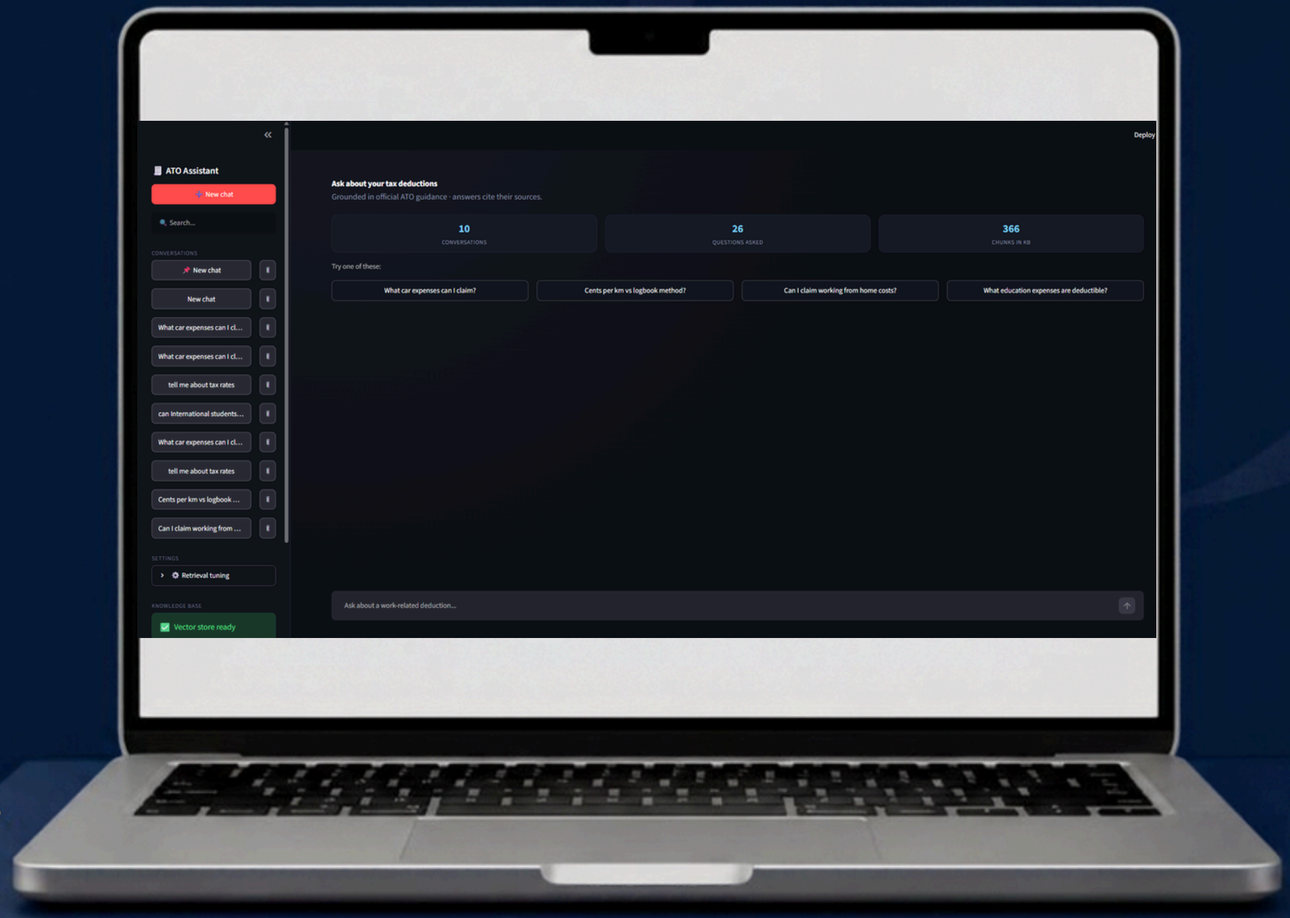
   ANSWERED

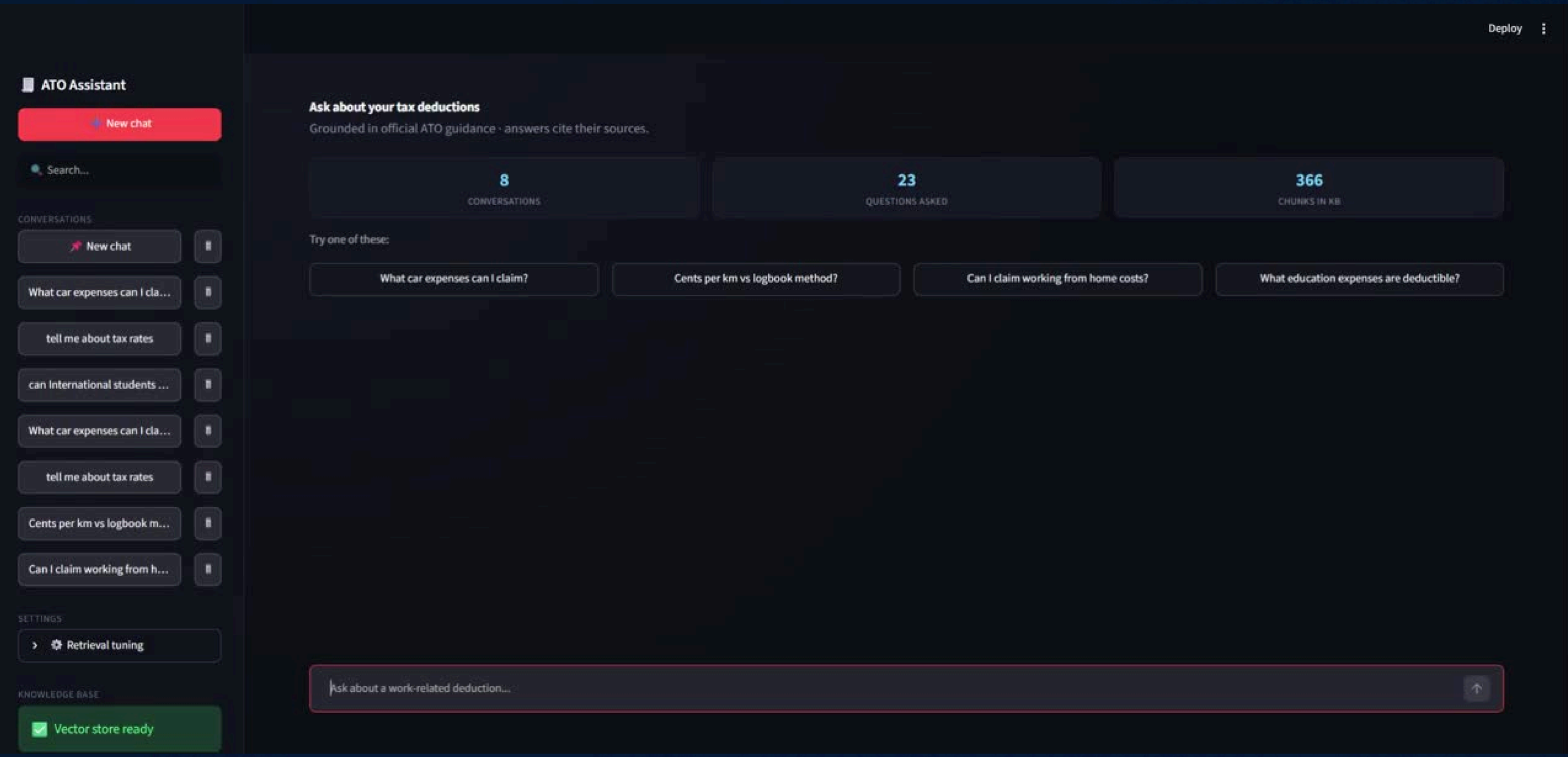
2. **What about if I lease it instead?**
   Understands “it” and re-retrieves

   FOLLOW-UP

3. **Can I claim my superannuation contributions?**
   Refuses instead of guessing

   REFUSED




Deploy
ATO Assistant
New chat
Search...
CONVERSATIONS
New chat
What car expenses can I cla...
tell me about tax rates
can International students ...
What car expenses can I cla...
tell me about tax rates
Cents per km vs logbook m...
Can I claim working from h...
SETTINGS
Retrieval tuning
KNOWLEDGE BASE
Vector store ready
Ask about your tax deductions
Grounded in official ATO guidance · answers cite their sources.
8
CONVERSATIONS
23
QUESTIONS ASKED
366
CHUNKS IN KB
Try one of these:
What car expenses can I claim?
Cents per km vs logbook method?
Can I claim working from home costs?
What education expenses are deductible?
Ask about a work-related deduction...

Evaluation
Right call: answer or refuse

Scores whether the system correctly answered or refused

Covers in-scope, edge-case and out-of-scope questions

Two real bugs found and fixed

Hallucinated superannuation answer now caught by a relevance threshold

28/28

scored questions correct

on a 30-question set;
2 deliberately vague questions flagged for manual review rather than auto-scored.

Why it matters?
and where does it go next?

Faster answers

Source-backed responses instead of dense government pages

Trustworthy by design

Refuses rather than guesses — critical when real money is on the line

Room to grow

Content-level checks and careful expansion beyond work-related deductions

Now → Next

Thank you

SJ

Shreesh Anil Joshi

RAG Pipeline

AM

Athith Mukkalu Suresh Babu

Evaluation Engineer

SN

Sahana Nataraja

Data Engineer

BS

Brunda Shankar

Frontend Engineer

VS

Vaishnavi Sreenath

Frontend Engineer

Scan to explore our repository

Questions welcome.